



Navigating the Digital Age: Spotting AI-Generated Content and Misinformation

In today's world, artificial intelligence has become a powerful tool for creation and innovation. However, it's equally capable of deception. This presentation explores the critical skills needed to identify deepfakes, misinformation, and AI-generated content. We'll equip you with practical tools and strategies to navigate the digital landscape safely, helping you become a savvy, critically-thinking online user who can distinguish truth from manipulation.

Understanding Deepfakes and AI-Generated Deception

What Are Deepfakes?

Deepfakes represent one of AI's most sophisticated and potentially dangerous applications. These are AI-generated videos, photos, or audio clips that convincingly show people doing or saying things they never actually did. The technology has become remarkably realistic, making it increasingly difficult to spot fake content with the naked eye.

Common Forms of AI Deception

- Fabricated video footage of public figures making false statements
- Cloned voice messages impersonating friends or colleagues
- Fake news articles designed to manipulate emotions
- AI-generated social media profiles spreading misinformation

Whilst these technologies can serve legitimate purposes in entertainment and art, they're increasingly weaponised for fraud, manipulation, and spreading disinformation at scale.



📌 **Critical Alert:** Deepfakes are becoming more sophisticated every day. What seems obviously fake today might be indistinguishable from reality tomorrow.

Your Digital Defence Toolkit: Verification Strategies and Resources

Becoming digitally literate means developing a healthy scepticism and mastering verification techniques. Before believing or sharing content, always pause and investigate.



Critical Questions

- Who created this content?
- Why was it made?
- Where did it originate?
- Can I verify it through trusted sources?



Red Flags to Spot

- Sensational headlines with excessive capitalisation
- Missing or unclear authorship
- Awkward grammar or formatting
- Images that seem too perfect
- Extreme emotional language



Verification Tools

- **Google Reverse Image Search** – trace image origins
- **InVID/Reality Defender** – analyse videos for manipulation
- **Snopes.com** – verify news and rumours
- **Bot Sentinel** – detect suspicious social media accounts

Your **critical thinking** is your greatest defence. Slow down before reacting, sharing, or forming strong opinions based on online content. Remember: not everything that looks real is genuine, and not everything shocking is true. By applying these verification strategies and using digital detective tools, you'll navigate the online world with confidence and wisdom, protecting yourself and others from manipulation.